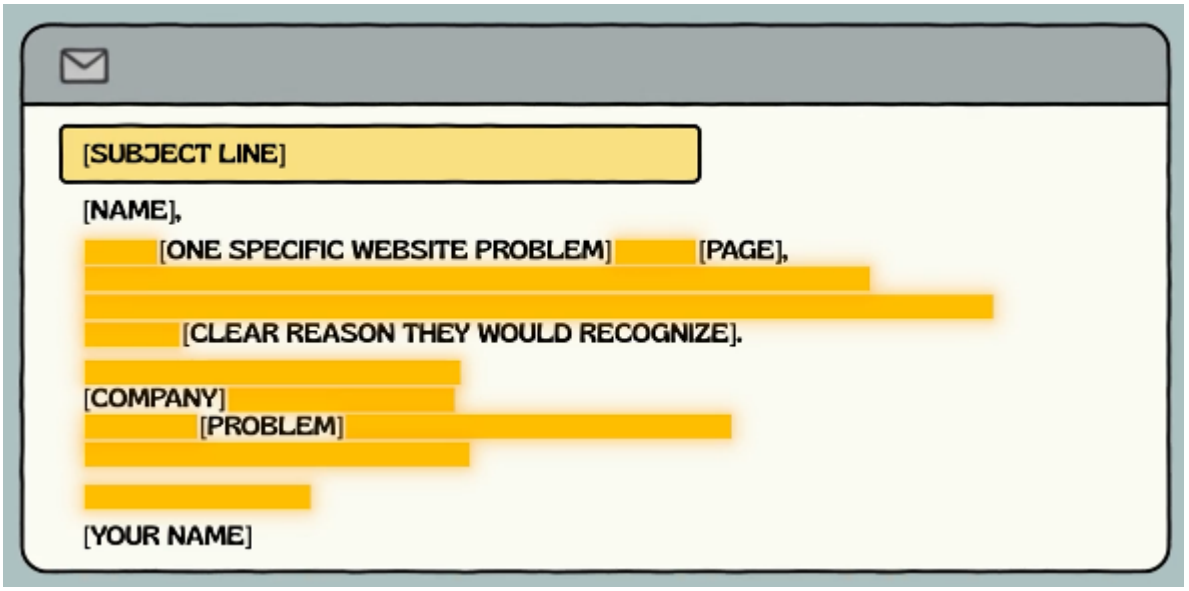
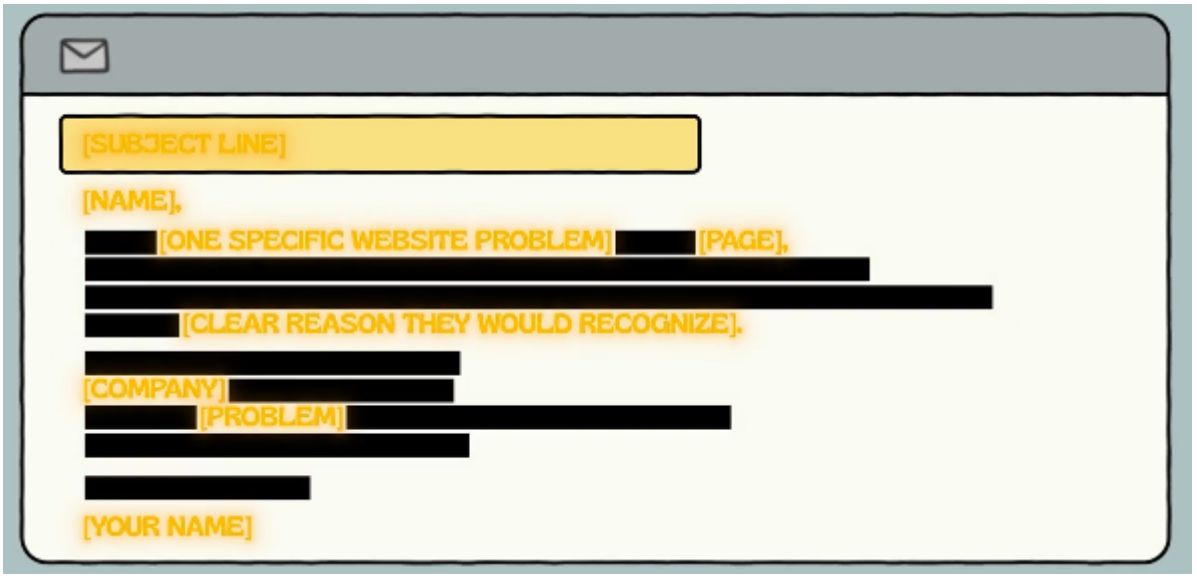
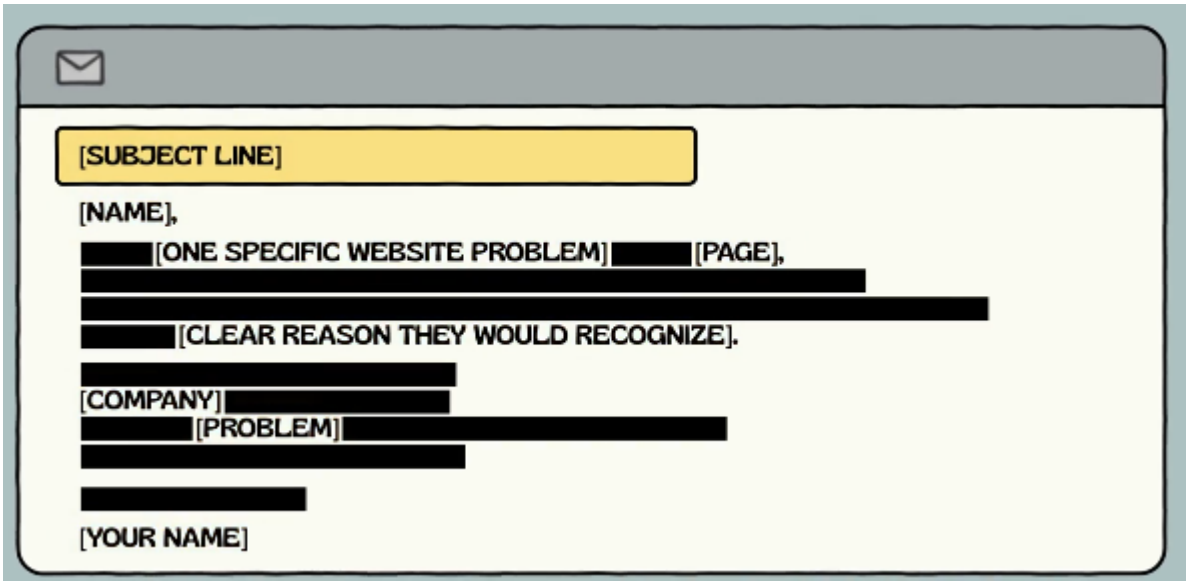
Email X Variable Y

X - What you can't see, the hidden structure, the parts that stay mostly consistent across prospects.



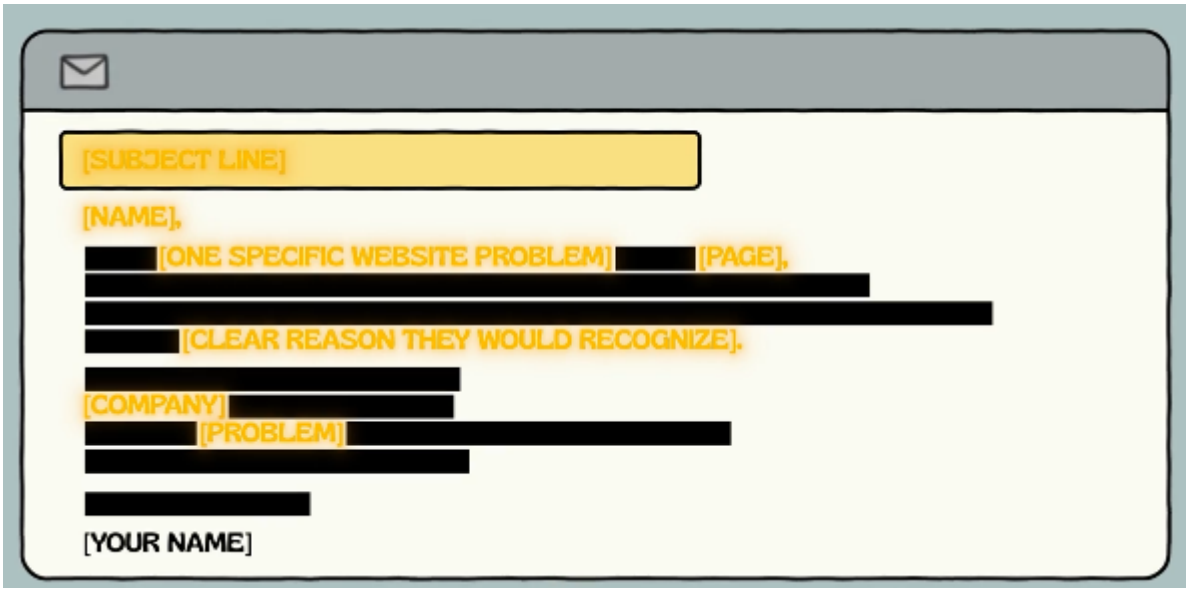
Y - What you can see, the brackets, the inputs that must change per prospect.





Email X is the delivery mechanism, Variable Y is the proof of relevance.

What is Variable Y in the system?
Variable Y is not everything that changes, Variable Y is a small set of fields that prove you looked, and prove your message is about their business, not about you.



In this system, Variable Y is only the first name, the company name, website, the page, website problem, recognisable reason, consequence mechanism, and the subject line.

Anything else is not a Variable and it belongs inside email X, as structure, posture, and risk reversal.

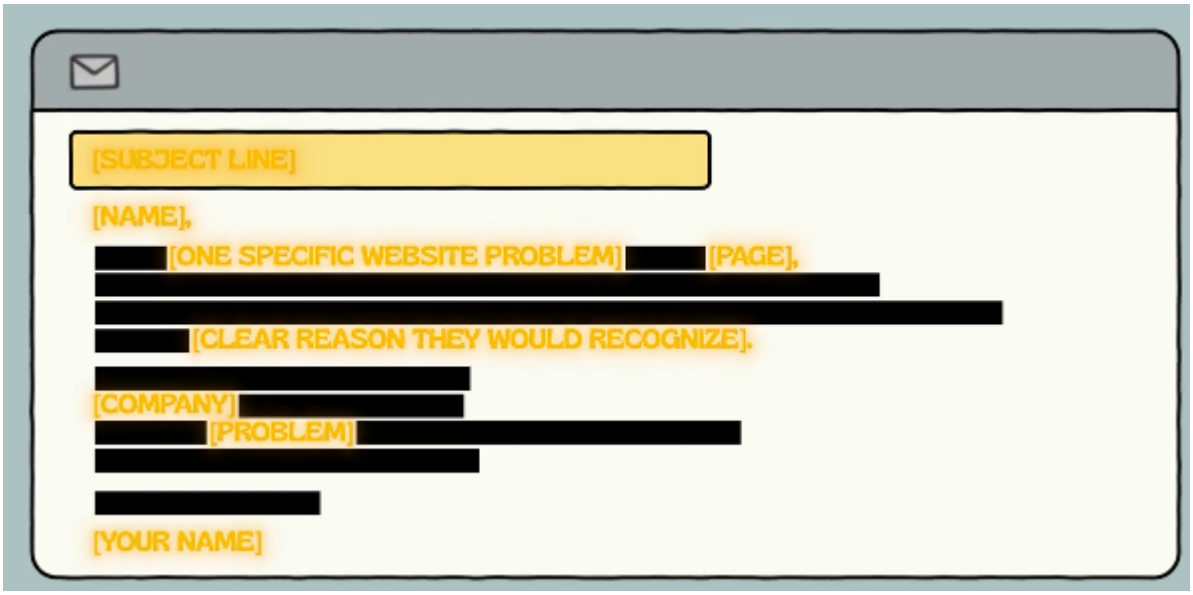
Cold emailing works when

3 Feelings:

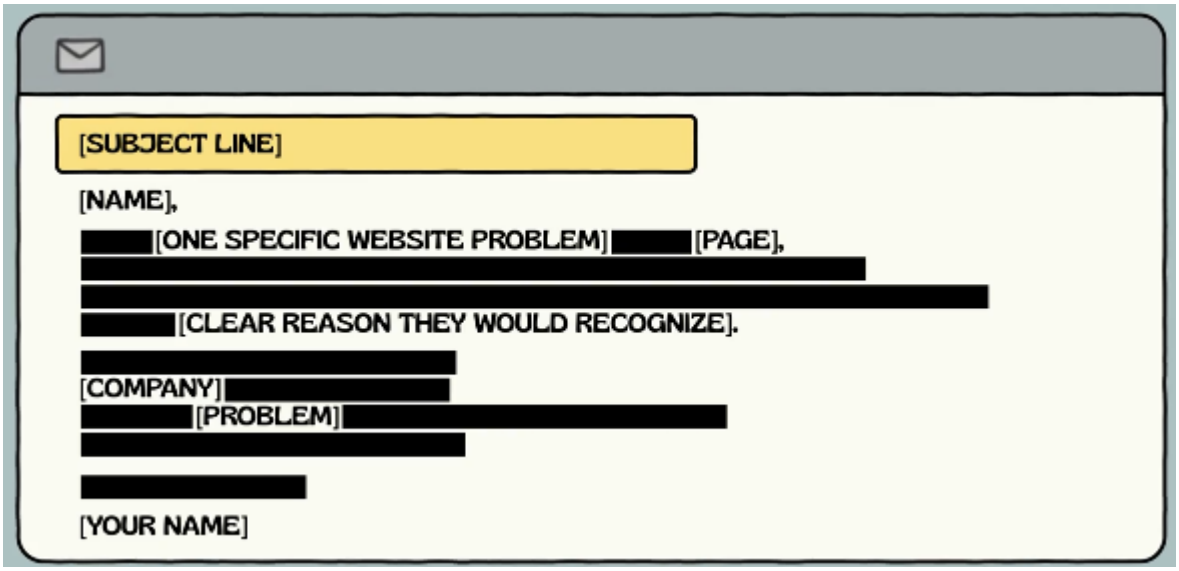
- This is about me
- This reduces risk
- This moves towards a clear next step without pressure

Rules

- Everything in brackets must be observable or conditional - observable means they can verify it publicly, conditional means you can describe common buyer behaviour without claiming you measured their business.

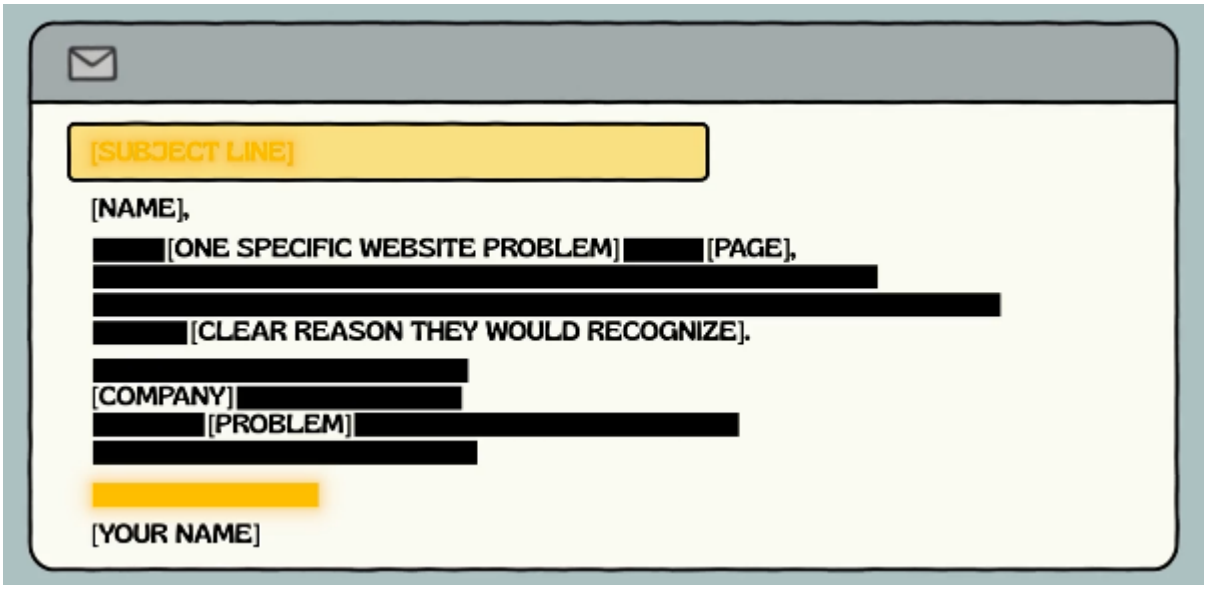


- One lane only - lane is a customer's next step. If the next step is booking, stay in booking.



- One friction only - not a list, not an audit, one point of hesitation tied to one page or one step.
- No internal measurement claims - don't measure conversion rate, don't state what visitors do as a fact, don't claim revenue loss, describe mechanisms, not metrics.

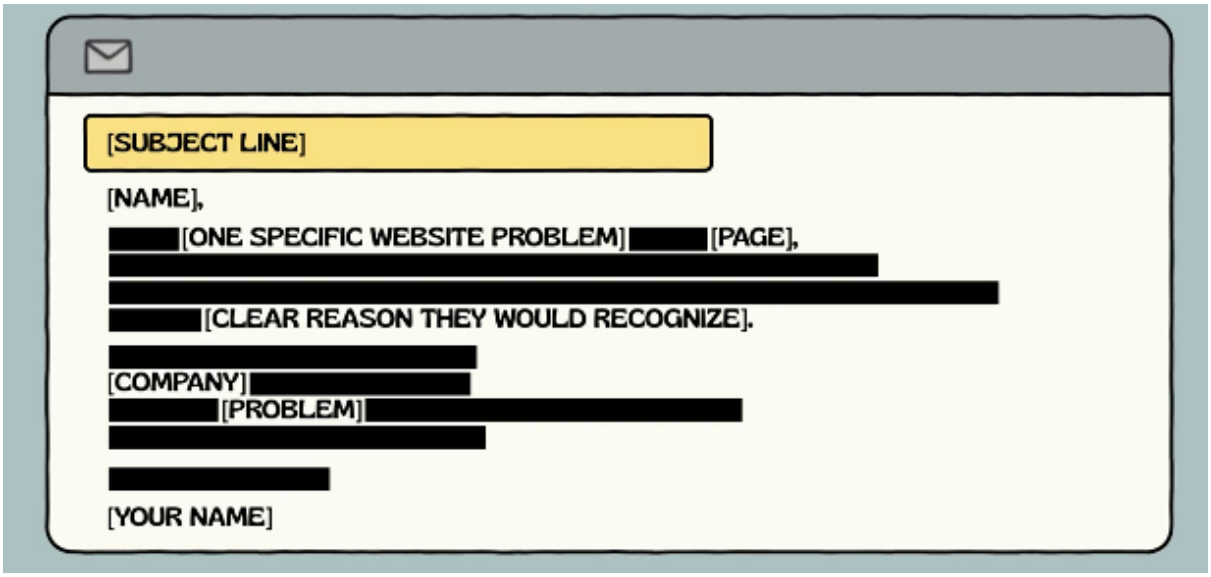
- No judgemental language - you're not accusing, you're describing the buyer experience at a step.
- The subject line must mirror the micro yes - the subject line labels the decision the email asks for. If the subject pimples one decision, and the body asks for another, it reads like bait, and gets ignored.



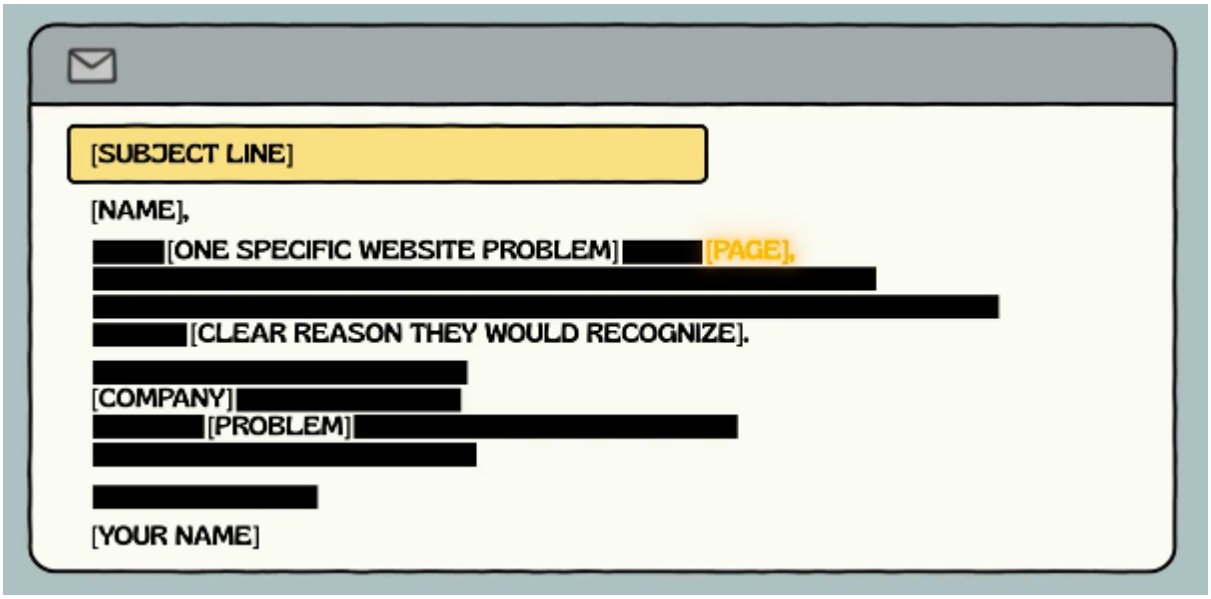
- If a variable is weak, don't compensate with more words - Don't write harder, choose a better friction, or sip the lead.

Decision Logic

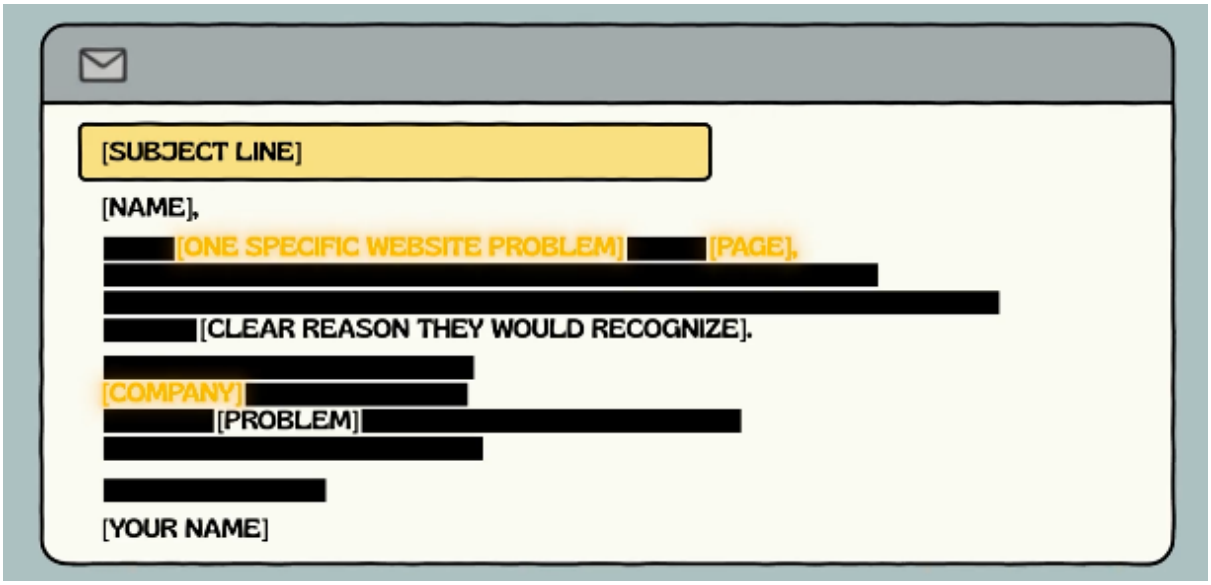
Exact order to build variable Y



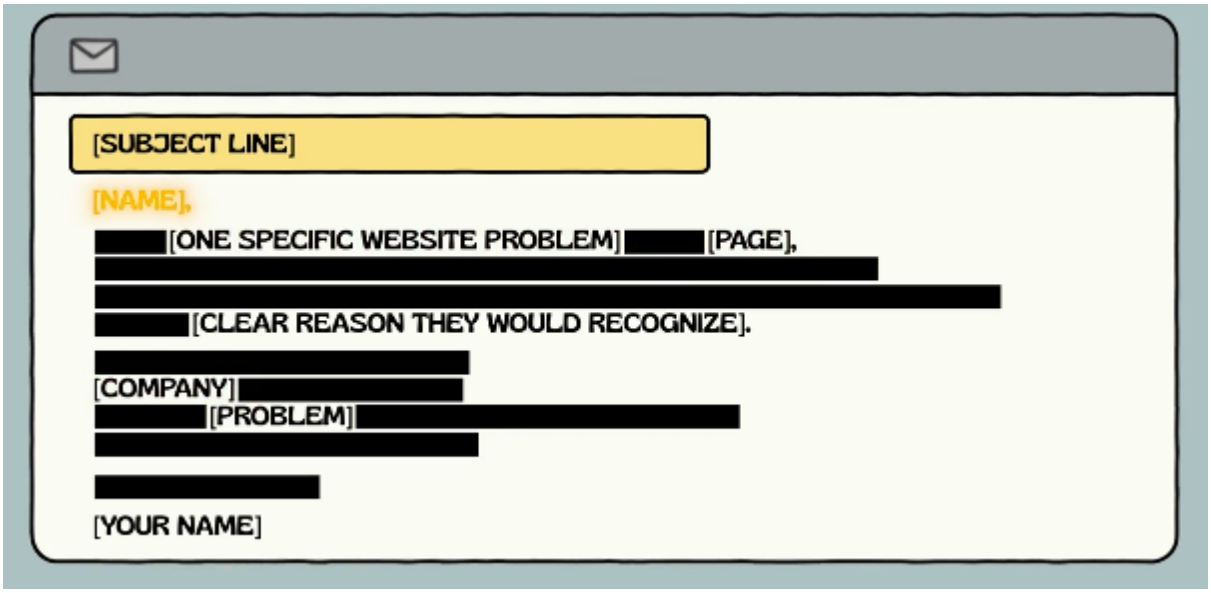
1. First, You need to define the customer's next step - what is the single action the buyer must take for the business to win? Book a call, submit, buy - If you can't name the next step, you can't be specific.
2. Second, Choose the lane - the lane is where the action happens. A page, a form, a checkout, or a booking widget. One lane only.
3. Third, Lock the location - this becomes your page, the exact page or step label they can open instantly.



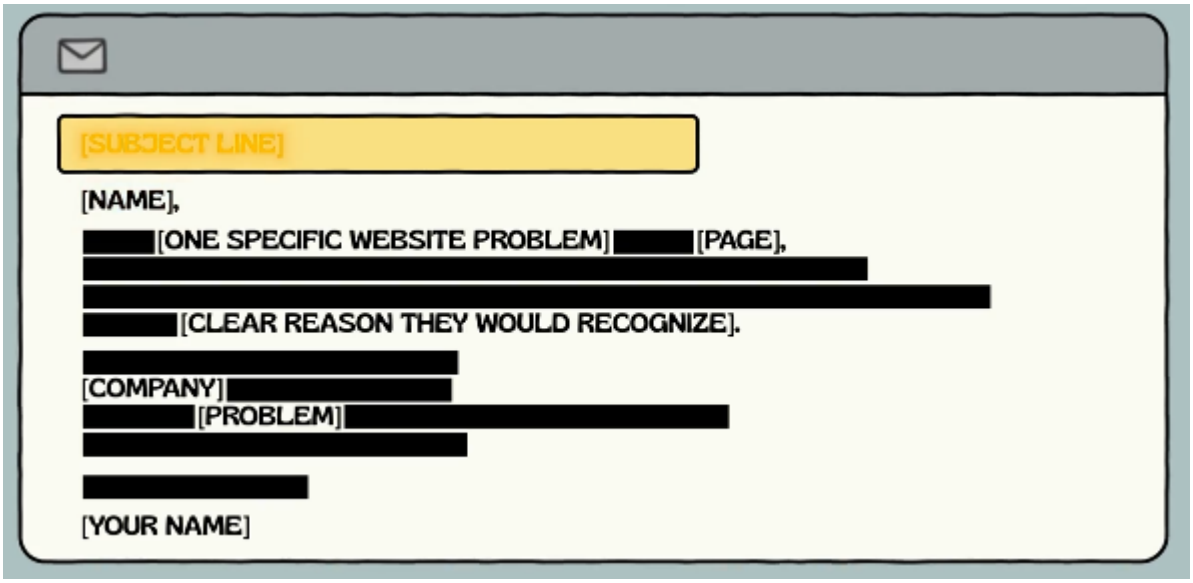
4. Find one friction - this becomes your website problem, a fiction isn't style, colour or opinion, it's something that creates hesitation or uncertainty at the decision step. Valid friction passes three tests - Visible, Fast, so it's under 10 seconds, logical, it lives on one page or step, and it's decision tied, it affects willingness or ability to take the next step. If it fails any of these tests, don't use it.
5. Write the recognisable reason, this becomes your recognisable reason. It's the buyer's behaviour pattern that makes the operator nod. Standard - if a stranger can read it, and instantly picture a real visitor doing it, it passes.
6. Write consequence mechanics - this becomes your consequence mechanics, cause and effect without numbers.
7. Set website and company name - use the brand name the use on the site, keep it consistent across touches.



8. Choose first name only if you're sure - a wrong name is worse than no name.



9. Write the subject line - the subject is a decision label that matches the micro-yes in the email X. It should preview the same permission asked within the body



Common mistakes

- Using vague frictions - if you can't point it out clearly, it isn't real
- Using multiple frictions - that turns the email into an audit
- Writing a recognisable reason like an accusation - if the reader feels attacked, they won't reply
- Writing consequence mechanics like you saw analytics - operators can smell it, it triggers scam radar instantly
- Writing a subject line that reads like an AD - your subject line isn't a headline, it's a decision label

10 second send test

- Can they verify the issue in one click?
- Is the friction one thing, not a list?
- Is the friction tied to the customer's next step?
- Is a recognisable reason a behaviour, not a marketing phrase?
- Is the consequence mechanics a chain reaction without numbers?
- Does the subject line match the decision the email asked for?
- Would the email be safe to forward internally?

If any answer is no, Don't send.
If you find a valid friction, don't force it.